

```
pdfTeX 3.14159265-2.6-1.40.15 (TeX Live 2014)
hithu@linux:~$ tex --version
TeX 3.14159265 (TeX Live 2014)
```

Scilab

Apart from a calculator, array based computation is the next step to engineering or scientific research. MATLAB is known for such high level numerical computation but it is a proprietary software. Scilab is an open source equivalent of MATLAB. It was created in 1990 by researchers from INRIA and ENPC in France. It is freely available for all computation platforms (refer to my article in the January 2017 issue of *OSFY*). The Scilab version in my computer is:

```
hithu@linux:~$ scilab -version
Scilab version "5.5.0.1397209685"
```

Inkscape

High resolution images with diverse formats, such as scalable vector graphics (svg), can be flawlessly achieved with this open source software. It has all the flexibility to interact with LaTeX and it has become my favourite drawing platform.

```
hithu@linux:~$ inkscape --version
Inkscape 0.48.4 r9939 (Jan 22 2014)
```

Zotero

Researchers should give valid citations or bibliographies to support their claims. There are numerous bibliography management software packages available. Zotero is free and open source, adequate for almost all of your citation needs.

```
hithu@linux:~$ zotero --version
Zotero 4.0.28
```

LibreOffice

We are all helplessly dependent on Microsoft Office. But the MS Office package comes with a price. MS Excel is the favourite of many engineers. Its equivalent is LibreOffice Calc, which helps in managing data adequately. Its limitations can be overcome with programming skills. Slide preparation and writing is bypassed by LaTeX. My present version of LibreOffice is:

```
hithu@linux:~$ libreoffice --version
LibreOffice 4.2.8.2 429m0(Build:2)
```

Artha

A dictionary is one of the overlooked components in any computer. It is good to have a dictionary handy. It is also possible to set shortcut keys of your favourite to access the word you want on your screen, at the click of a button. Artha works fine for my vocabulary skills.

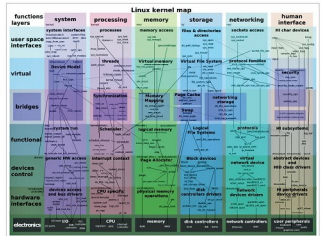


Figure 1: Linux kernel map

The version I use is:

```
hithu@linux:~$ artha --version
2012
```

Calibre

Richard Dawkins once said, "Where I come from, a scholar is somebody who's read more than one book." Reading books in an e-reader or smartphone is current trend. Personally, I own a Kindle device. Calibre manages and converts all that's in my digital library in an elegant way.

```
hithu@linux:~$ calibre --versioncalibre(calibre 1.25)
```

VLC Media Player

Whether it's video lectures or your favourite sci-fi movie, VLC supports almost all formats. It has good networking capabilities and will remain favourite media software. The present version of VLC Media Player is:

```
hithu@linux:~$ vlc --version
VLC media player 2.1.6 Rincewind (revision 2.1.6-0-gea1d28)
```

Firefox

An Internet browser can be considered as another operating system. Cloud computing has made it possible to work with anything online nowadays. Firefox is a clean browser with an easy interface and many add-ons. Bookmarks with a facility to export, root access and private browsing settings make it flexible. I prefer this open source browser.

```
hithu@linux:~$ firefox --version
Mozilla Firefox 50.1.0
```



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